Joining tables

Data engineering · Level 3 · Lesson 3



In this lesson you will

- Join tables with JOIN … ON.
- Keep every row with LEFT JOIN, and find gaps with IS NULL.
- Judge a result: rows missing or counted twice?

Key ideas

- Inner joins drop what doesn’t match.
- Left joins keep it, as NULL.
- One row per match: count with care.

Join with cards

1. Deal (3 min): two sets of cards
2. Inner (4 min): match only
3. Left (4 min): every member
4. Count (4 min): rows and members

Give one member three loan cards and one loan a number nobody has.

Let's discuss

1. Why did some members vanish in the inner join?
2. How do you find members who never borrowed?
3. Why did COUNT(*) say 9 when there were 5 borrowers?

Exit ticket

- Write a LEFT JOIN that finds pupils with no mark.